



Emerson Gray

HR DIRECTOR · EVERGREEN & PINE CO.

"Keeps everyone's secrets. Professionally."



FOR EMERSON GRAY'S EYES ONLY

Do not show these pages to anyone, including the host.

WHO YOU ARE (EVERYONE KNOWS THIS)

You are the HR Director of Evergreen & Pine Co. You look after hiring, policies, bonus letters and, tonight, the microphone: you are the party's MC.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Bart Pringle:** six years of hiring and staff events together.
- **Walt Evergreen:** you introduced Walt's speech at the toast.
- **Rory Bennett:** your HR assistant.



YOUR PARTY ACCESSORY

A cream knit scarf and a holiday name badge. No full costume needed.

HOW THIS BOOKLET WORKS

1. Before the party, read pages 1 and 2 alone.
2. Page 3 holds Rounds 1 and 2. Fold it so only Round 1 shows; open Round 2 only when called.
3. Page 4 is Round 3 and your notes: keep it shut until Round 3.
4. You may help a team, but never vote for yourself.

THE CASE (EVERYONE KNOWS THIS)

At 4:15 pm Bart Pringle, VP of Sales, opened a Secret Santa gift: a tin of peppermint fudge. About twenty minutes later Bart collapsed. Every gift had waited on the side-hallway table, and ten people are suspects.

YOUR EVENING AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive wearing your accessory and name tag.
2. Detective Holloway reads Script 1.
3. Three Rounds: reveal, ask, mission.
4. Ballots, then the big reveal.

PAGE 1	PAGE 2	PAGE 3 · ROUND 1	PAGE 3 · ROUND 2	PAGE 4 · ROUND 3
Who you are Public facts	Your secret Story & goal	Tonight	New twists	Final answers + Notes



You are innocent. You did not harm Bart, but you do have something to hide.



Your private background

KEEP IT QUIET

YOUR STORY

You joined six years ago and turned a two-drawer filing cabinet into a real HR team. People trust you with their worries, so you know more secrets than anyone in the building.

YOUR SECRET: DO NOT REVEAL IT UNTIL A ROUND TELLS YOU TO

Last month HR received an anonymous complaint about Bart's expense claims. On Tuesday you met Bart behind closed doors. Bart left red in the face and told you, "When I'm CEO in January, HR will need a new director." You also carry the master keys to every office, and today you left them on your desk all afternoon.

WHERE YOU WERE AT 3:35–3:50 PM

From 3:35 to 3:50 pm you were at the microphone in the main hall as MC of the welcome toast, in your cream knit scarf. You are in the 3:42 pm toast photo.

YOUR GOAL TONIGHT

Keep the expense complaint confidential until Round 3, explain the master keys, and help the teams find the truth.

GUESTS MAY ASK YOU

- **G10: "Did anyone borrow your keys today?"** "Nobody. They're still on my desk, and no office was found unlocked."
- **G12: "Did Bart book any meetings for Monday?"** "Yes: Monday 9 am with Walt, marked urgent. Bart said it was about money, not people."
- **G17: "What was your Tuesday meeting with Bart about?"** Before Round 3: "That's confidential." From Round 3: "An HR review of Bart's expense claims."

How to play this booklet: open each Round (page 3: Rounds 1–2, page 4: Round 3) only when Detective Holloway calls it.

BEFORE THE PARTY, CHECK OFF

- ☐ I know my alibi for 3:35–3:50 pm by heart.
- ☐ I have my party accessory ready.
- ☐ I have NOT peeked at pages 3–4.

NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Rounds 1 & 2

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Round 1



Read only when Detective Holloway starts Round 1

REVEAL

- You were MC of the welcome toast from 3:35 to 3:50 pm, at the microphone the whole time.
- Everyone was asked to come to the main hall for the toast, so the side hallway should have been empty.
- Bart booked an urgent meeting with Walt for Monday at 9 am and told you, "It's about money, not people, so HR isn't needed."

ASK

Ask **Rowan Pike**: "Were you at the toast? I didn't see you from the microphone."

MISSION

Lead a quick round of applause for the best holiday accessory in the room.

IF ACCUSED

"I had a microphone in my hand and forty people looking at me. Hard to sneak off."

✂ **Fold here.** Keep Round 2 folded under until Detective Holloway calls **Round 2**.

❄ Round 2



Read only when Detective Holloway starts Round 2

REVEAL

- About the scarf clue: yes, you wear a scarf, but at 3:40 you were at the microphone in front of everyone.
- Your master keys sat on your desk all afternoon. They are still there, and no office was found unlocked.
- You met Bart on Tuesday. Say only that it was “confidential.”

ASK

Ask **Kendall Brooks**: "Did Bart treat you fairly this year?"

MISSION

Remind every team, kindly, that suspects can't vote for themselves.

IF ACCUSED

"I spent the toast introducing Walt. Ask anyone who was there."

NOTES: WHO SAID WHAT?

[illegible]

Round 3

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❄️ **Stop.** Keep this page folded shut until Detective Holloway calls **Round 3**.

❄️ Round 3



Read only when Detective Holloway starts Round 3

- REVEAL

- Admit your secret: HR was reviewing a complaint about Bart’s expense claims, and Bart threatened your job once Bart became CEO.
 - The complaint was about Bart’s own small expenses. It had nothing to do with suppliers or invoices.
 - On Thursday at about 7 pm you saw Rowan Pike still at the copier, with the label printer humming.
- ASK

Ask **Avery Quill**: “Who was meant to keep an eye on the gift table during the toast?”
- MISSION

Ask each team captain for a one-word guess, with no reasons.
- IF ACCUSED

“Bart’s threat worried me. But I deal with problems in meetings, not with sweets.”

Notes

SUSPECT QUICK LIST (PUBLIC)

NAME	ROLE	NAME	ROLE
Avery Quill	Office Manager	Emerson Gray	HR Director
Rowan Pike	Finance Lead	Skyler Moss	Intern
Jesse Marlow	Marketing Lead	Drew Calder	Caterer
Kendall Brooks	Top Sales Rep	Reese Whitfield	Rival Company Rep
Parker Lane	IT Support	Finley Dale	Founder’s Assistant